

ATMs At Worm Risk?

Some anti-virus firms, including Trend Micro and Computer Associates, are trying to create a new market for themselves—by persuading banks, that ATMs running Windows need protection from worms. Rival companies are questioning this.



Hi-fi Through Wi-Fi

Creative's "Sound Blaster Wireless Music" uses a Wi-Fi network to stream your MP3s to your stereo. The idea is that you keep your PC and wireless access point in one room, the receiver and the stereo in another, while you sit with your remote in a third room.



Enter

Kapil Dev

Cricketing Legend

He led India to its sole World Cup win in 1983, and ended his 16-year long career as the highest wicket taker in test cricket. He now commentates and plays golf. **What does technology mean to you?**

It means progress.

Technology gives you knowledge; the evolution of man from a caveman to a master of machines shows its effect on our living.

How do you use technology in everyday life?

I am an SMS-freak, and my office uses technology to the maximum. Thanks to my PC, and the Internet, I get reports in no time.

How has technology influenced sports?

Cricket has benefited a lot. Run-out decisions have been eased, thanks to Hawkeye. Also, we get a better perspective of any match, unlike the old times where there was just a replay mechanism for viewers.

Can technology ever replace umpiring?

The instant reaction that one gets from an umpire can hardly be replaced by any machine. Technology will always assist umpiring. It is fun to see the umpire's hand going up rather than wait for the red light to flash.

Who is more tech savvy—your wife or daughter?

My daughter Amya is growing up with technology and so I think she is way ahead of both of us when it comes to using technology.

Aparna Krishnakumar

DREAM ROBOT

He's A Sony

It's a cross between the Asimo and the Aibo: it's humanoid, like the Honda Asimo, and it's a pet, like the Sony Aibo. It's QRIO, Sony's "Dream Robot"—a "Small Biped Entertainment Robot" under development by Sony Corporation.

Walking properly, not falling, and so on, are feats amazing in themselves; but what is probably most fascinating about QRIO is that it recognises and understands spoken sentences, and responds through voice and body gestures.

How cool is that? As if that were not enough, QRIO can also distinguish individuals by vocal and facial features! By memorising and using information specific to an individual, QRIO will actually be able to hold "intimate" and "rich" conversations.

So has the future finally arrived? A little pet "entertainment" robot that holds conversations sure sounds like the future.

QRIO is capable of sensing and understanding its environment in three dimensions. It can locate the direction of a sound. It can walk avoiding obstacles, courtesy its stereo camera. With suitable landmarks around, QRIO will be able to kick a football. It can adapt to "inclined and irregular

terrain." It can walk, swagger, and dance. It will re-stabilise itself when "external forces affect its balance." And when it does fall over, it can bend over backwards to minimise the shock of the fall.

With such a repertoire, we are tempted to call QRIO a "he" rather than an "it" (He definitely looks male). QRIO is powered by three 64-bit RISC processors, and just three 64 MB DRAM sticks. He weighs about seven kilos with his battery. We're wondering how much he will cost if and when he hits the shelves.



MUKESH AMBANI

The Most Influential Person In Telecom

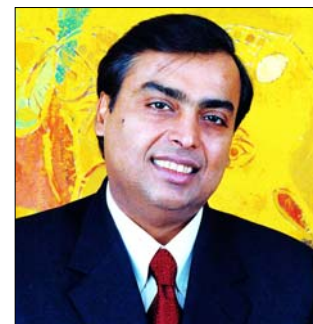
Mukesh Ambani, chairman of Reliance Infocomm and now, chairman of FLAG Telecom, has won this year's prestigious World Communication Award as the "most influential person in telecommunications in 2004". Ed McCormack, Executive Vice President, Corporate Development,

FLAG Telecom, received the award on the night of October 11 on behalf of Ambani at a ceremony at London.

The World Communications Awards are sponsored by the leading global telecom publication, *Total Telecom*. The most influential person in telecommunications is chosen by the publication's readers.

Acknowledging the honour, Ambani said in a statement: "The award is ... associated with a recognition of the rapidly growing influence of India in the global telecom arena."

"In India, Reliance Infocomm is spearheading a massive telecom revolution with the vision to become a



Mukesh Ambani, is the "most influential person in telecommunications"

major global player over the next decade. Also, the strategic acquisition of FLAG Telecom will place India at the forefront of the global broadband revolution."

Here's the interesting part for the rest of us:

